The Coin and the Toy

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 13

Nib admired the bright toy token on Farm Quay's table. A plain coin-shaped token lay beside the current borrowing slip. The toy belonged to another activity. Lark held Train's request next to the lending instructions while the book remained safely on its cart.

“A joyful toy,” Nib declared hopefully. “A useful coin-shaped token,” Lark replied with a smile.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **boat**

“Oi in coin and join writes the same vowel sound as oy in toy,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read coin and toy right through. Similar sounds don't make the objects interchangeable; their words and the instructions tell us their different jobs.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try coin, toy, join. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read coin on the lending instruction,” Lark invited gently. “Which token belongs with this borrowing slip?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The coin is by the toy. I can join the team.**

“Which two things are beside each other?” Lark asked gently. “Does the other sentence describe an object or a person joining?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib attached the coin-shaped lending token to Train's current slip. The toy stayed on its own activity tray. The borrower's identity and request now matched, but a hauling strap still stretched across the cart's exit. Lark kept the book aboard until that route was clear.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write coin beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark recorded the token check without marking the loan finished. Your journal showed the correct slip ready. One taut strap still had to leave the route before Train could reach its borrower.